

Name: _____

Period: _____

Date: _____

Topic 0.4 Guided Notes: Research Design and Ethics

Unit 0: Science Practices | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic0.4

Word Bank

<i>Confidentiality</i>	<i>Quantitative Research</i>
<i>Institutional Review Board (IRB)</i>	<i>Qualitative Research</i>
<i>Confederate</i>	<i>Informed Assent</i>
<i>Debriefing</i>	<i>Likert Scale</i>
<i>Informed Consent</i>	<i>Protection from Harm</i>

1. Choosing a Research Design

- _____: research that translates the social world into numbers that can be treated mathematically (e.g. the exact number of seconds it takes a mouse to run a maze).
- _____: research that focuses on non-numerical data, such as subjective experiences, feelings, or beliefs (e.g. analyzing interview transcripts).

To turn subjective feelings into hard numbers, psychologists often use _____s — a survey response scale that asks respondents to rate their level of agreement on a range.

2. The Laboratory vs. Everyday Life

The goal of a lab experiment is not to perfectly recreate the exact behaviors of everyday life, but to test the underlying theoretical principles — the value of simplified laboratory conditions is that they allow researchers to isolate cause and effect by controlling all confounding variables.

3. The Rules of the Game: Ethics

Before any data can be collected, every study must be approved by an _____ — a committee that reviews research proposals to ensure they are ethical and protect the rights, safety, and well-being of participants.

The Core Ethical Guidelines for Human Participants

- _____: giving participants enough information about a study so they can voluntarily decide whether to participate.
- _____: agreement from a minor (or someone who cannot legally give full consent) to participate, after the research has been explained in a way they can understand.

- _____: researchers must ensure participants do not suffer undue physical or psychological harm.
- _____: personal information obtained from a participant should not be revealed without permission.
- _____: if deception is used (sometimes involving a _____ — an actor secretly working for the researcher), the researcher MUST provide a post-experimental explanation of the study's true purpose.

Apply It: Identify the Ethical Guideline

Using the word bank above, write which ethical guideline each scenario best illustrates.

#	Scenario	Guideline
1	Before joining a study, each adult participant reads and signs a form explaining the study's purpose, procedures, and any risks.	
2	A 9-year-old agrees to take part in a school study after a researcher explains it in simple terms, and his parent also signs off.	
3	After a study using deception, the researcher meets with each participant to explain the true purpose and reveal the deception used.	

Why Study Animals?

Because humans and animals share common biology, studying a rat or a pigeon can reveal fundamental laws of behavior. Animal research must be approved through the same kind of institutional review process, and is strictly governed by ethical codes requiring humane care, healthy living conditions, and the minimization of pain.

4. AP Science Practice Focus: Ethical Scenarios

Practice 2.D requires you to evaluate whether a psychological research scenario followed appropriate ethical procedures — playing the role of the IRB and checking whether the researcher respected consent, confidentiality, and debriefing.

The AAQ Exam Connection

On Part D of the AAQ, you must first identify one ethical guideline that the researchers successfully followed, then describe how they applied it. Scan the article for clues: Did participants sign a waiver? (Informed Consent). Were their names removed from the data? (Confidentiality). Did the researcher explain the trick at the end? (Debriefing).

5. Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

_____ means absolutely no one knows who the participants are, not even the researcher collecting the data.

_____ means the researcher does know who you are, but ethically promises to keep that information a secret from the public.

Is psychology 100% objective? No — psychologists' personal values heavily influence what topics they choose to study and how they apply their results.

6. Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. A researcher records the exact number of minutes it takes each participant to solve a puzzle, allowing her to calculate an average completion time across the whole sample. This is an example of:
 - A. Informed Assent
 - B. Quantitative Research
 - C. A Likert Scale
 - D. Qualitative Research
2. Before beginning a new study on memory, a team of researchers must first submit their research proposal to a university committee that reviews it to ensure the study is ethical and protects participants' rights and safety. This committee is called the:
 - A. Peer Review Committee
 - B. Institutional Review Board (IRB)
 - C. Debriefing Panel
 - D. American Psychological Association (APA)
3. A researcher knows exactly which participants provided which survey responses, but promises that this information will never be shared publicly or connected to their names in any report. This ethical guideline is best described as:
 - A. Protection from Harm
 - B. Anonymity
 - C. Informed Consent
 - D. Confidentiality
4. In a study on conformity, an actor secretly working for the research team pretends to be a regular participant and deliberately gives an obviously wrong answer to see how it influences the real participants. This actor is known as a:
 - A. Confounding Variable
 - B. Case Study Subject
 - C. Confederate
 - D. Control Group Member
5. After a study involving deception ends, the researcher sits down with each participant to fully explain the true purpose of the study and reveal any deceptions that were used, making sure everyone leaves feeling okay. This process is called:
 - A. Debriefing
 - B. Informed Consent
 - C. Random Assignment
 - D. Peer Review



Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the [Unit 0 Quiz](https://appsychreviewhub.com/quiz) to test what you've learned:

<https://appsychreviewhub.com/quiz>